

WRAPROWS Function in Excel

1. What is WRAPROWS?

The WRAPROWS function takes a single row or column of values and wraps it into a table, filling one row at a time. You decide how many values go in each row. It solves the problem of long lists that are hard to read or print. A Data Analyst uses it to reshape lists into compact tables and to split a list into rows of equal size, such as months into quarters.

2. Syntax

`=WRAPROWS(vector, wrap_count, [pad_with])`

Argument	Required?	What it accepts
vector	Required	A single row or a single column of values (for example A1:A6). A table with several columns and rows does not work.
wrap_count	Required	The maximum number of values in each row, which is the width of the result. A value of 3 means 3 columns.
pad_with	Optional	The value to put in any empty cells, such as "" or "-". The default is #N/A.

Excel fills the first row from left to right, then starts a new row below. It works out the number of rows itself: 6 values with a wrap_count of 3 make 2 rows, and 7 values make 3 rows with 2 empty cells.

3. Simple Example

Wrap a list of 6 items into rows of 3:

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Apple		Apple	Banana	Orange
2	Banana		Mango	Kiwi	Grape
3	Orange				
4	Mango				
5	Kiwi				
6	Grape				

Formula in C1 only: `=WRAPROWS(A1:A6, 3)`

Each row holds 3 values. Excel fills the first row with Apple, Banana, Orange, then starts a second row with Mango, Kiwi, Grape. **Result: 2 rows and 3 columns**

4. Another Example

Arrange 5 monthly sales figures into rows of 3 (one quarter per row):

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Sales		Month 1	Month 2	Month 3
2	120		120	150	130
3	150		170	160	-
4	130				
5	170				
6	160				

Formula in C2 only: `=WRAPROWS(A2:A6, 3, "-")` (the headings in C1:E1 are typed)

Five values make two rows. Row 1 gets 3 values. Row 2 gets only 2, so the empty cell is filled with the pad value "-" instead of #N/A.

5. When to Use It

- Turn a long list into a compact table for reading or printing
- Break daily or monthly figures into weeks or quarters, one row per period
- Split a list into groups of equal size, one group per row
- Arrange list items in a grid layout for a report or dashboard
- Rebuild a table from a flattened list, for example after using TOCOL

6. Important Things to Remember

- WRAPROWS fills row by row: left to right, then down. Its partner WRAPCOLS fills column by column.
- wrap_count is the number of values in each row (the table width), not the number of rows.
- vector must be a single row or column, or Excel shows #VALUE!. A wrap_count below 1 gives #NUM!.
- Empty cells show #N/A unless you give a pad_with value.
- WRAPROWS is a dynamic array function. The cells for the result must be empty, or Excel shows #SPILL!.
- WRAPROWS is available in Microsoft 365 and Excel 2024, but not in Excel 2021 or earlier.

7. Common Mistakes

Mistake: Thinking wrap_count is the number of rows. `=WRAPROWS(A1:A6, 3)` gives 2 rows and 3 columns, not 3 rows. **Fix:** To get 3 rows from 6 values, use a wrap_count of 2.

Mistake: Selecting a range with several columns, which gives #VALUE!. **Fix:** Use a single row or column. Flatten a table first with TOCOL or TOROW.

Mistake: Leaving #N/A in the result because pad_with was left out. **Fix:** Add a pad value, such as "".

Mistake: Mixing up WRAPROWS and WRAPCOLS and getting the values in the wrong order. **Fix:** WRAPROWS fills across rows. WRAPCOLS fills down columns.

8. Data Analyst Tip

To get a set number of rows, calculate the wrap_count. For example, `=WRAPROWS(A2:A20, ROUNDUP(COUNTA(A2:A20)/3, 0), "")` wraps the list into 3 rows, however many items there are.